SSC CGL 2024 Tier-I question paper with answers

25 September 2024 · Shift 2

82 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 18 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/Writeup_Final_Anwerkey_CGLE_2024_T1_191224.pdf

Compare your score: the official 2024 cut-off (Tier-I, all posts except JSO and SI Grade-II), out of 200

UR 153.19 **OBC** 146.26 **EWS** 142.02 **SC** 126.46 **ST** 111.89 **ESM** 69.93 **OH** 113.10 **HH** 64.79 **VH** 102.97 **Other PwD** 45.74

Cut-offs apply to marks normalised across all the exam's shifts, so a raw score on one shift is a rough guide. Source: the official result write-up, https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/NoticeBoards/Result%20Write-up%20CGLE%202024%20Tier%20I_51224.pdf

General Intelligence and Reasoning 18 questions

Q.1

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.
66, 75, 86, 99, 114, ?

(A) 131
(B) 140
(C) 139
(D) 135

Q.2

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 139 + 40 ÷ 5 – 168 × 3 = 283

(A) + and ÷
(B) – and ×
(C) ÷ and ×
(D) – and +

Q.6

Select the correct combination of letters that when sequentially filled in the blanks of the given series will make the series logically complete. B_FH_LNP_T_X

(A) CKSU
(B) DIQU
(C) CIQW
(D) DJRV

Q.7

'Obstinate' is related to 'Stubborn' in the same way as 'Resolute' is related to '_____'. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must not be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word.)

(A) Wavering
(B) Thoughtful
(C) Dithering
(D) Determined

Q.8

The position of how many letters will remain unchanged if all the letters in the word RICKET are arranged in English alphabetical order?

(A) One
(B) None
(C) Three
(D) Two

Q.9

Two sets of numbers are given below. In each set of numbers, certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number result(s) in the second number. Similarly, certain mathematical operation(s) on the second number result(s) in the third number and so on. Which of the given options follows the same set of operations as in the given sets? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 8 – 33 – 66 – 81; 11 – 36 – 72– 87

(A) 21 – 46 – 82 – 107

(B) 18 – 43 – 86 – 100

(C) 15 – 40 – 80 – 95

(D) 6 – 31 – 62 – 97

Q.11

18 is related to 90 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 31 is related to 155. To which of the following is 52 related, following the same logic? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed)

(A) 265

(B) 260

(C) 248

(D) 256

Q.13

17 is related to 102 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 29 is related to 174. To which of the following is 39 related, following the same logic? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed)

(A) 228

(B) 234

(C) 230

(D) 238

Q.14

All the alphabets in the word ‘CARDBOARD’ are arranged in the alphabetical order. How many alphabets are there in the English alphabetical series between the alphabet which is fourth from the left end and the one which is second from the right end in the newly formed cluster of nine letters?

(A) 14

(B) 16

(C) 12

(D) 10

Q.15

Three of the following four options are alike in a certain way and thus form a group. Which is the one that does NOT belong to that group? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 36 – 88 – 80

(B) 68 – 54 – 94

(C) 34 – 56 – 62

(D) 23 – 56 -51

Q.16

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow from the statements. Statements: All papers are pencils. All pencils are erasers. All erasers are pens. Conclusions: I. All pens are papers. II. Some papers are erasers. III. Some pens are pencils.

(A) All the conclusions follow
(B) Only conclusions I and III follow
(C) Only conclusions II and III follow
(D) Only conclusions I and II follow

Q.17

In a certain code language, 'CLERK' is written as 'BKEQJ' and 'OFFICE' is written as 'OEEIBE'. How will 'POST' be written in that language?

(A) RSOO
(B) OORS
(C) OROS
(D) OSOR

Q.18

Based on the English alphabetical order, three of the following four letter-clusters are alike in a certain way and thus form a group. Which is the one that DOES NOT belong to that group? (Note: The odd man out is not based on the number of consonants/vowels or their position in the letter-cluster.)

(A) QST
(B) TWW
(C) IKL
(D) ACD

Q.20

In a certain code language, A + B means 'A is the son of B', A – B means 'A is the wife of B', A × B means 'A is the brother of B' and A ÷ B means 'A is the mother of B'. Based on the above, how is T related to P if 'P – M + R ÷ T × S'?

(A) Sister
(B) Husband's brother
(C) Brother's wife
(D) Brother

Q.22

Which two numbers (not digits) should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 15 + 5 × 8 – 72 ÷ 4 + 16 × 3 = 101

(A) 15 and 16
(B) 5 and 4
(C) 8 and 4
(D) 5 and 3

Q.23

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. EYES : FTFZ :: MIND : OENJ :: REST : ?

(A) STRE
(B) STSF
(C) TUFS
(D) TUSF

Q.24

In the following series, only one letter-cluster is incorrect. Select the incorrect letter-cluster. ZXU SQN LKI ECZ XVS

(A) LKI
(B) ECZ
(C) XVS
(D) SQN

Q.25

In a certain code language, 'DRAPE' is coded as '65432' and 'TAPED' is coded as '24596'. What is the code for 'R' in that language?

(A) 9
(B) 6
(C) 2
(D) 3

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Which of the following states is one of those states that have no Panchayati Raj Institution at all?

(A) Assam
(B) Nagaland
(C) Gujarat
(D) Punjab

Q.2

In which month is the Inter Tropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ) located around 20°N-25°N latitude (over the Gangetic plain)?

(A) June
(B) July
(C) May
(D) August

Q.3

Which of the following is an example of capital receipts?

(A) Grants-in-aid from other governments
(B) Interest on government bonds
(C) Revenue from the sale of government assets
(D) Taxes on income

Q.4

Jaipal Singh Munda is associated with which of the following sports?

(A) Hockey
(B) Kabaddi
(C) Cricket
(D) Badminton

Q.5

In January 2023, Koneru Humpy won India's first-ever silver medal at the _____ held in Almaty, Kazakhstan.

(A) World Correspondence Chess Championship
(B) FIDE World Chess Championship
(C) World Rapid Chess Championship
(D) World Blitz Chess Championship

Q.6

Bihu festival is the main festival of which state?

(A) Kerala
(B) Punjab
(C) Assam
(D) Rajasthan

Q.7

The New Moore Island is in geographic proximity to:

(A) Bangladesh
(B) Myanmar
(C) Pakistan
(D) Sri Lanka

Q.8

During the period of 1947 to 1990, how many five-year plans were completed?

(A) 7
(B) 6
(C) 8
(D) 9

Q.9

Who among the following sent Megasthenes to the court of Chandragupta Maurya?

(A) Alexander III
(B) Seleucus I Nicator
(C) Antiochus I Soter
(D) Antiochus III

Q.10
Which of the following is NOT a member of the Aves (birds) class?

(A) Psittacula
(B) Struthio
(C) Neophron
(D) Pteropus

Q.11
When you take Lead nitrate powder in a boiling tube and heat it, you will observe the emission of brown fumes that are of _____.

(A) Nitrogen dioxide
(B) Nitric oxide
(C) Nitrous oxide
(D) Dinitrogen trioxide

Q.12
Which of the following playback singers is the recipient of the Karnataka Ratna Award 2005?

(A) Ravindra Jain
(B) Pandit Jasraj
(C) Sistla Janaki
(D) Bhimsen Joshi

Q.13
'Drain of Wealth', a critique of the colonial exploitation, was given by which of the following nationalist leaders?

(A) Chakravarti Rajagopalachari
(B) Rajendra Prasad
(C) Dadabhai Naoroji
(D) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

Q.14
Who founded the Theosophical Society in New York in 1875?

(A) Ramabai Ranade and GK Devadhar
(B) Baba Dayal Das and Madan Lal
(C) Madame HP Blavatsky and Colonel Olcott
(D) Naoroji Furdunji and Satyendra Nath Bose

Q.15
Mirabai Chanu secured a silver medal at which Commonwealth Games?

(A) 2014
(B) 2018
(C) 2010
(D) 2022

Q.16
Who is the author of the book 'From Plassey to Partition and After : A History of Modern India'?

(A) Romila Thapar
(B) Sumit Sarkar
(C) Sekhar Bandyopadhyay
(D) Devid Hardiman

Q.17
Who has written the book Sangeet Bal Prakash?

(A) Vishnu Narayan Bhatkhande
(B) Vishnu Digambar Paluskar
(C) Bhimsen Joshi
(D) Pandit Narayan Rao

Q.18
What is the name of the inflammatory condition that causes cracks, crusting and scaling at the corners of the mouth due to vitamin B2 deficiency?

(A) Cheilosis
(B) Psoriasis
(C) Atopic dermatitis
(D) Urticaria

Q.19
Which of the following rivers originates from the Himalayas?

(A) Ganga
(B) Narmada
(C) Tapi
(D) Godavari

Q.20
Which of the following Delhi sultans introduced two coins, namely silver tanka and copper jital?

(A) Bahlul Lodi
(B) Qutbuddin Aibak
(C) Iltutmish
(D) Ghiyasuddin Balban

Q.21
In Pradhan Mantri Gramin Awaas Yojana, the cost of unit assistance is shared between Central and State Governments in the ratio _____ for the North-Eastern and the Himalayan states.

(A) 60 : 40
(B) 90 : 10
(C) 45 : 55
(D) 50 : 50

Q.22
As per article 158, the Governor shall NOT be a member of either House of Parliament or of a House of the Legislature of any State specified in _____ Schedule.

(A) Seventh
(B) Third
(C) Fifth
(D) First

Q.23
Name the straight chain alkane having chemical formula C_9H_{20}, which is used as a research chemical and in making biodegradable detergents.

(A) Nonane
(B) Nonadecane
(C) Dodecane
(D) Icosane

Q.24
According to the Tea Board of India's report (2021-22), which group of states in India is the largest tea producer?

(A) Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand
(B) West Bengal and Assam
(C) Andhra Pradesh and Kerala
(D) Tamil Nadu and Kerala

Q.25
If a 12-year-old is found to be working in a factory manufacturing carpets, which of the following Articles of the Constitution of India will be violated?

(A) Article 26
(B) Article 25
(C) Article 23
(D) Article 24

Quantitative Aptitude 14 questions

Q.1
In the 8th class, consisting of 30 students, a Mathematics test was taken. 10 students had an average score of 90. The other students had an average score of 75. What is the average score of the whole class?

(A) 78
(B) 74
(C) 80
(D) 76

Q.2
The relation between K_1 and K_2 for which the system of linear equations $K_1x + 3y = 8$ and $4x + K_2y = 16$ represents coincident lines, is:

(A) $K_2 = 3K_1$
(B) $K_1 + K_2 = 0$
(C) $K_2 = K_1$
(D) $K_2 + 3K_1 = 0$

Q.4

In a quadrilateral ABCD, AB = BC, AD = DC. ∠ABD = 68°, ∠ADB = (2y-7)°, ∠BDC = 33°, ∠DBC = (3x+2)°. Then the value of 2x+3y is:

(A) 104
(B) 108
(C) 118
(D) 144

Q.5

Find the value of tan 72° – tan 27° – tan 72° tan 27°.

(A) –1
(B) 0
(C) 1
(D) –2

Q.7

A policeman noticed a thief at some distance. The policeman started running to catch the thief and the thief also started running at the same time. The speed of both policeman and the thief was 12 km per hour and 10 km per hour, respectively. It took 30 minutes for the policeman to catch the thief. Find the initial distance (in metres) between them.

(A) 1000
(B) 600
(C) 100
(D) 500

Q.10

A man loses 28% by selling an article for ₹144. If he sells it for ₹288, what will be his gain/loss percentage?

(A) Loss, 43%
(B) Gain, 44%
(C) Gain, 41%
(D) Loss, 46%

Q.11

If A:B = 6 : 8 and B:C = 5 : 11, then A:B:C is:

(A) 14:31:25
(B) 15:32:44
(C) 15:20:44
(D) 11:23:14

Q.12

Naman borrows a sum of ₹3,48,020 at the rate of 8% per annum simple interest. At the end of the first year, he repays ₹15,090 towards return of principal amount borrowed. If Naman clears all pending dues at the end of the second year, including interest payment that accrued during the first year, how much does he pay (in ₹) at the end of the second year?

(A) 3,92,733
(B) 3,79,386
(C) 3,88,931
(D) 3,87,406

Q.14

The two circles intersect at two points P and Q. PR and PS are diameters of the two circles. What is ∠PQR ?

(A) 45°
(B) 0°
(C) 90°
(D) 60°

Q.15

Find the diameter (in cm) of a circle whose circumference is equal to the sum of the circumferences of two circles of radii 12 cm and 16 cm.

(A) 28
(B) 32
(C) 64
(D) 56

Q.16

If m is even, then $(8^m - 1)$ is divisible by:

(A) 8
(B) 65
(C) 42
(D) 63

Q.19

The ratio of expenditure to savings of a woman is 4 : 1. If her income and expenditure are increased by 20% and 10%, respectively, then find the percentage change in her savings.

(A) 50%
(B) 40%
(C) 60%
(D) 30%

Q.23

Simplify: [25 –48 ÷ 6 + 12 × 2] + 78 – [5 + 3 of (25 – 2 × 10)]

(A) 89
(B) 90
(C) 98
(D) 99

Q.24

Find the value of 'k' for which the system of equations 4x+6y=7 and 6x+(k+4)y-21=0 has a unique solution.

(A) $k \neq 5$
(B) $k \neq 7$
(C) $k = 5$
(D) $k = 7$

English Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Select the sentence that does NOT have a spelling error.

(A) She is very particular about pronounciation in her classes.
(B) The movie was very successful in the urban areas, but not among rural audiences.
(C) There wedding was during the summer, which is why we didn't attend it.
(D) There were no intermittent showers in the city, as was predicted during the whether forecast.

Q.2

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. P- for a Q- exercise daily R- one must S- good body

(A) PRSQ
(B) PQRS
(C) PRQS
(D) RQPS

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The ship launched out on a "journey by water or sea" of discovery.

(A) voyage
(B) verso
(C) rendezvous
(D) vespers

Q.4

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Nominal

(A) Nasty
(B) Significant
(C) Sound
(D) Constant

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Ashoka was the greatest "than all the Mauryan Emperors" .

(A) to other Mauryan Emperors
(B) of the Mauryan Emperors
(C) to all another Mauryan Emperors
(D) all Mauryan Emperors

Q.6

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who eats human flesh.

(A) Scavengers
(B) Omnivores
(C) Cannibal
(D) Herbivores

Q.7

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. He and his friends / does not / want to / attend the meeting.

(A) attend the meeting
(B) want to
(C) does not
(D) He and his friends

Q.8

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Bombastic

(A) Elevated
(B) Simple
(C) Wicked
(D) Pastoral

Q.9

Select the option that expresses the following sentence in passive voice. He had cleaned the bathroom.

(A) The bathroom had been cleaned by him.
(B) The bathroom has been cleaned by him.
(C) The bathroom has cleaned by him.
(D) The bathroom had cleaned by him.

Q.10

The following sentence has been divided into four segments. Identify the segment in which the article has been used INCORRECTLY. In the recent past, the IT industry has emerged / as a major contributor to an industry revenue / as well as employment / opportunity provider in the country.

(A) as a major contributor to an industry revenue
(B) In the recent past, the IT industry has emerged
(C) opportunity provider in the country.
(D) as well as employment

Q.11

Select the option that correctly expresses the given sentence in passive voice. Why didn't she bring her son to my house?

(A) Why isn't her son brought to my house?
(B) Why wasn't her son brought to my house?
(C) Why wasn't her son brought by her to my house?
(D) Why isn't her son brought by you to my house?

Q.12

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Forgive

(A) Requite
(B) Clear
(C) Unburden
(D) Loathe

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined part of the following sentence. My brother always received "the lion's share" of every meal that we had.

(A) the major portion
(B) the pet's share
(C) the last bite
(D) a very small part

Q.14

Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the following sentence. Parul is known as a rigteous and honest lady.

(A) lady
(B) honest
(C) rigteous
(D) known

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined part in the following sentence. We all have to “pull our socks up” for the upcoming Board exam, if we want to get outstanding grades.

(A) revive interest in old matters
(B) calm down impudent contempt
(C) act in a proper manner
(D) work harder than before

Q.16

Select the option that can substitute/replace the bracketed word correctly and complete the sentence. I said I (don’t) understand.

(A) done
(B) am doing
(C) didn’t
(D) doesn’t

Q.17

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. (a) the Industrial Revolution denotes (b) and continued until the middle of the 19th century (c) a significant period of social, economic and technological revolution (d) that commenced in the latter part of the 18th century

(A) dcba
(B) cadb
(C) abcd
(D) acdb

Q.18

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word in brackets to fill in the blank. He said that he lacks the _____ to stand in a queue. (patience)

(A) elegance
(B) acceptance
(C) endurance
(D) relevance

Q.19

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word in the brackets to fill in the blank. The pool was too _____ at this end for kids to play. [SHALLOW]

(A) green
(B) cold
(C) blue
(D) deep

Q.20

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Concede

(A) Avow
(B) Battle
(C) Deny
(D) Surrender

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. We naturally seek the company of those whose (1) _____ are the same as our own. Fools do not like the (2) _____ of wise men, and wise men avoid fools. Serious-minded people do not find much in common with (3) _____ folk, and vice versa. Sinners feel uncomfortable with (4) _____ and do not seek their company. We can, therefore, as a rule, judge a man's (5) _____ by the company he keeps.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) institutes
(B) organisations
(C) apathy
(D) tastes

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. We naturally seek the company of those whose (1) _____ are the same as our own. Fools do not like the (2) _____ of wise men, and wise men avoid fools. Serious-minded people do not find much in common with (3) _____ folk, and vice versa. Sinners feel uncomfortable with (4) _____ and do not seek their company. We can, therefore, as a rule, judge a man's (5) _____ by the company he keeps.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) serious
(B) antagonist
(C) culture
(D) company

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. We naturally seek the company of those whose (1) _____ are the same as our own. Fools do not like the (2) _____ of wise men, and wise men avoid fools. Serious-minded people do not find much in common with (3) _____ folk, and vice versa. Sinners feel uncomfortable with (4) _____ and do not seek their company. We can, therefore, as a rule, judge a man's (5) _____ by the company he keeps.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) frivolous
(B) grave
(C) solemn
(D) thoughtful

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. We naturally seek the company of those whose (1) _____ are the same as our own. Fools do not like the (2) _____ of wise men, and wise men avoid fools. Serious-minded people do not find much in common with (3) _____ folk, and vice versa. Sinners feel uncomfortable with (4) _____ and do not seek their company. We can, therefore, as a rule, judge a man's (5) _____ by the company he keeps.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) rowdy
(B) commoners
(C) saints
(D) knave

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. We naturally seek the company of those whose (1) _____ are the same as our own. Fools do not like the (2) _____ of wise men, and wise men avoid fools. Serious-minded people do not find much in common with (3) _____ folk, and vice versa. Sinners feel uncomfortable with (4) _____ and do not seek their company. We can, therefore, as a rule, judge a man's (5) _____ by the company he keeps.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) heirloom

(B) legacy

(C) futurities

(D) character

Answer key

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**
Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**
Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**
Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**				

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (A) 131

The differences are 9, 11, 13, 15, rising by 2 each time, so the next is 17: 114 + 17 = 131.

Q.2 · Answer (C) ÷ and ×

After interchanging ÷ and ×: 139 + 40 × 5 – 168 ÷ 3 = 139 + 200 – 56 = 283.

Q.6 · Answer (D) DJRV

The series takes every second letter: B D F H J L N P R T V X. The blanks are D, J, R and V.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Determined

'Obstinate' and 'stubborn' mean the same, as do 'resolute' and 'determined'.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Two

In alphabetical order RICKET becomes C E I K R T. Only K (fourth) and T (sixth) keep their places.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 15 – 40 – 80 – 95

Each set goes +25, × 2, +15: 8 → 33 → 66 → 81 and 11 → 36 → 72 → 87. Likewise 15 → 40 → 80 → 95.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 260

Each number is multiplied by 5: 18 × 5 = 90 and 31 × 5 = 155. So 52 × 5 = 260.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 234

Each number is multiplied by 6: 17 × 6 = 102 and 29 × 6 = 174. So 39 × 6 = 234.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 14

CARDBOARD in alphabetical order is A A B C D D O R R. The fourth from the left is C and the second from the right is R; between C and R come D to Q: 14 letters.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 68 – 54 – 94

The middle number is twice the difference of the outer two: 2 × (80 – 36) = 88, 2 × (62 – 34) = 56 and 2 × (51 – 23) = 56. In 68 – 54 – 94, 2 × (94 – 68) = 52, not 54.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Only conclusions II and III follow

All papers are pencils and all pencils are erasers, so some papers are erasers (II). All pencils are erasers and so pens, so some pens are pencils (III). I does not follow: papers lie inside pens, not pens inside papers.

Q.17 · Answer (B) OORS

Each consonant moves one letter back and each vowel stays: CLERK → BKEQJ and OFFICE → OEEIBE. So POST → OORS.

Q.18 · Answer (B) TWW

In QST, IKL and ACD the letters move +2, then +1. TWW moves +3, then 0, so it is the odd one.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Husband's brother

P is the wife of M, M is the son of R, R is the mother of T and T is the brother of S. M and T are both R's sons, so T is P's husband's brother.

Q.22 · Answer (D) 5 and 3

Interchanging 5 and 3: 15 + 3 × 8 – 72 ÷ 4 + 16 × 5 = 15 + 24 – 18 + 80 = 101.

Q.23 · Answer (D) TUSF

The two halves swap places and each letter moves one forward: EY ES → ES EY → FTFZ and MI ND → ND MI → OENJ. So RE ST → ST RE → TUSF.

Q.24 · Answer (A) LKI

In ZXU, SQN, ECZ and XVS the letters step back 2, then 3 (in ECZ, C – 3 wraps round to Z), and each cluster starts 7 letters before the last. LKI steps back 1, then 2; the cluster should be LJG.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 3

D, A, P and E are in both words, as are 6, 5, 4 and 2 in both codes. The letter left in DRAPE is R and the digit left in its code is 3, so R = 3.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Nagaland

Under Article 243M, Part IX (the panchayats) does not apply to Nagaland, Meghalaya and Mizoram, which keep their own traditional village councils.

Q.2 · Answer (B) July

By NCERT's account, in July the ITCZ lies around 20°N-25°N over the Gangetic plain, where it is called the monsoon trough.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Revenue from the sale of government assets

Selling government assets (disinvestment) brings in a capital receipt, as it reduces the government's assets. Taxes, interest and grants are revenue receipts.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Hockey

Jaipal Singh Munda captained India's hockey team at the 1928 Amsterdam Olympics, where India won its first Olympic hockey gold.

Q.5 · Answer (D) World Blitz Chess Championship

Koneru Humpy won silver in the women's section of the World Blitz Chess Championship at Almaty, which ended on 30 December 2022: the first medal by an Indian woman at that event.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Assam

Bihu, celebrated three times a year (Bohag, Kati and Magh Bihu), is the main festival of Assam.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Bangladesh

New Moore Island (South Talpatti) rose in the Bay of Bengal off the mouth of the Hariabhanga river, on the India-Bangladesh border, and was claimed by both countries.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 7

Seven plans ran in this period, from the First (1951-56) to the Seventh (1985-90); the Eighth began only in 1992.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Seleucus I Nicator

Seleucus I Nicator sent Megasthenes as his envoy to Chandragupta Maurya's court at Pataliputra, which Megasthenes described in his 'Indica'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Pteropus

Pteropus is the flying fox, a fruit bat, and so a mammal. Psittacula (parakeets), Struthio (the ostrich) and Neophron (the Egyptian vulture) are birds.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Nitrogen dioxide

Heated lead nitrate breaks down into lead oxide, nitrogen dioxide (the brown fumes) and oxygen: $2Pb(NO_3)_2 \rightarrow 2PbO + 4NO_2 + O_2$.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Bhimsen Joshi

Pandit Bhimsen Joshi, the Hindustani vocalist from Karnataka, received the Karnataka Ratna in 2005.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Dadabhai Naoroji

Dadabhai Naoroji set out the drain theory in 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Madame HP Blavatsky and Colonel Olcott

Madame H. P. Blavatsky and Colonel H. S. Olcott founded the Theosophical Society in New York in 1875; it later made Adyar, Madras, its headquarters.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 2014
Mirabai Chanu won silver in the women's 48 kg weightlifting at the 2014 Glasgow Commonwealth Games; she won gold in 2018 and 2022.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Sekhar Bandyopadhyay
'From Plassey to Partition and After' is Sekhar Bandyopadhyay's history of modern India.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Vishnu Digambar Paluskar
Vishnu Digambar Paluskar wrote 'Sangeet Bal Prakash', a three-volume series of music textbooks for students.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Cheilosis
Cheilosis (angular cheilitis), cracking and scaling at the corners of the mouth, is a classic sign of riboflavin (vitamin B2) deficiency.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Ganga
The Ganga rises from the Gangotri glacier in the Himalayas. The Narmada, Tapi and Godavari are peninsular rivers.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Iltutmish
Iltutmish introduced the silver tanka and the copper jital, the two basic coins of the Delhi Sultanate.

Q.21 · Answer (B) 90 : 10
Under PMAY-G the Centre and the states share the unit cost 60 : 40 in the plains and 90 : 10 in the North-Eastern and Himalayan states.

Q.22 · Answer (D) First
Article 158(1) bars the Governor from being a member of Parliament or of the legislature of any state specified in the First Schedule.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Nonane
Alkanes are C_nH_{2n+2}, so the one with nine carbon atoms, C_9H_{20}, is nonane. Dodecane has 12 carbons, nonadecane 19 and icosane 20.

Q.24 · Answer (B) West Bengal and Assam
Assam and West Bengal produce most of India's tea, Assam being the largest producer.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Article 24
Article 24 prohibits employing children below the age of 14 in factories, mines or other hazardous work.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (C) 80
Total = 10 × 90 + 20 × 75 = 900 + 1,500 = 2,400, so the average is 2,400/30 = 80.

Q.2 · Answer (A) $K_2 = 3K_1$
Coincident lines need $K_1/4 = 3/K_2 = 8/16 = 1/2$, so $K_1 = 2$ and $K_2 = 6$: $K_2 = 3K_1$.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 104
Triangles ABD and CBD are congruent (SSS), so ∠DBC = ∠ABD and ∠ADB = ∠BDC. Then 3x + 2 = 68, x = 22, and 2y − 7 = 33, y = 20: 2x + 3y = 44 + 60 = 104.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 1
tan 45° = (tan 72° − tan 27°)/(1 + tan 72° tan 27°) = 1, so tan 72° − tan 27° = 1 + tan 72° tan 27° and the expression is 1.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 1000
The policeman gains 12 − 10 = 2 km/h, so in 30 minutes he closes 1 km: they started 1,000 m apart.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Gain, 44%
CP = 144/0.72 = ₹200. Selling for ₹288 gains ₹88, which is 44% of ₹200.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 15:20:44
A : B = 6 : 8 = 3 : 4 = 15 : 20 and B : C = 5 : 11 = 20 : 44, so A : B : C = 15 : 20 : 44.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 3,87,406
First-year interest = 8% of ₹3,48,020 = ₹27,841.60. After the ₹15,090 repayment the principal is ₹3,32,930, earning ₹26,634.40 in the second year. Final payment = 3,32,930 + 27,841.60 + 26,634.40 = ₹3,87,406.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 90°
PR is a diameter, so ∠PQR is an angle in a semicircle: 90°.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 56
$2\pi R = 2\pi \times 12 + 2\pi \times 16$, so R = 28 cm and the diameter is 56 cm.

Q.16 · Answer (D) 63
With m = 2n, $8^m - 1 = 64^n - 1$, which is divisible by 64 − 1 = 63.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 60%
Take income 5, expenditure 4 and savings 1. The new income is 6 and the new expenditure 4.4, so savings become 1.6: a 60% rise.

Q.23 · Answer (D) 99
Brackets first: 25 − 8 + 24 = 41, and 5 + 3 × (25 − 20) = 5 + 15 = 20 ('of' means multiply). Then 41 + 78 − 20 = 99.

Q.24 · Answer (A) k ≠ 5
A unique solution needs $4/6 \neq 6/(k + 4)$, that is $k + 4 \neq 9$: $k \neq 5$.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) The movie was very successful in the urban areas, but not among rural audiences.
'Pronounciation' should be 'pronunciation', 'there wedding' 'their wedding' and 'whether forecast' 'weather forecast'.

Q.2 · Answer (D) RQPS
'One must (R) exercise daily (Q) for a (P) good body (S).'

Q.3 · Answer (A) voyage
A voyage is a long journey by sea or water: 'a voyage of discovery'.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Significant
'Nominal' means very small, or existing in name only; its opposite is 'significant'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) of the Mauryan Emperors
A superlative takes 'of', not 'than': 'the greatest of the Mauryan Emperors'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Cannibal
A cannibal is a person who eats human flesh.

Q.7 · Answer (C) does not
A subject joined by 'and' is plural: 'He and his friends do not want to attend the meeting.'

Q.8 · Answer (B) Simple
'Bombastic' means high-sounding and pompous; its opposite is 'simple'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) The bathroom had been cleaned by him.
The past perfect 'had cleaned' becomes 'had been cleaned': 'The bathroom had been cleaned by him.'

Q.10 · Answer (A) as a major contributor to an industry revenue
'Revenue' here is uncountable and takes no 'an': 'a major contributor to industry revenue' (or 'to the industry's revenue').

Q.11 · Answer (C) Why wasn’t her son brought by her to my house?
The past simple 'didn't bring' becomes 'wasn't brought', with the agent kept: 'Why wasn't her son brought by her to my house?'

Q.12 · Answer (D) Loathe
To forgive is to stop feeling resentment towards someone; SSC's key gives 'loathe', to hate intensely, as its opposite. 'Requite' (to pay back a wrong) is also arguable; 'clear' and 'unburden' are close to forgiving.

Q.13 · Answer (A) the major portion
The 'lion's share' is the largest part of something.

Q.14 · Answer (C) rigteous
The correct spelling is 'righteous'.

Q.15 · Answer (D) work harder than before
To 'pull one's socks up' is to make an effort to do better: to work harder than before.

Q.16 · Answer (C) didn’t
After a past reporting verb the reported present moves back: 'I said I didn't understand.'

Q.17 · Answer (D) acdb
'The Industrial Revolution denotes (a) a significant period of social, economic and technological revolution (c) that commenced in the latter part of the 18th century (d) and continued until the middle of the 19th century (b).'

Q.18 · Answer (C) endurance
'Endurance', the ability to bear something unpleasant without giving up, is close to 'patience' here.

Q.19 · Answer (D) deep
The opposite of 'shallow' is 'deep': the pool was too deep at this end for children.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Deny
To 'concede' is to admit that something is true; its opposite is to 'deny'. 'Surrender' is close in meaning.

Q.21 · Answer (D) tastes
We seek the company of those whose 'tastes' are the same as our own.

Q.22 · Answer (D) company
Fools do not like the 'company' of wise men: the passage is about the company we keep.

Q.23 · Answer (A) frivolous
'Frivolous' (not serious) folk are the opposite of the serious-minded.

Q.24 · Answer (C) saints
Sinners are uncomfortable with 'saints', their opposites.

Q.25 · Answer (D) character
We judge a man's 'character' by the company he keeps.

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